

Accessibility Audit Report

ExamForge AI | WCAG 2.1 AA | Generated: 2026-08-02

Executive Summary

The accessibility audit identified 36 findings across 6 categories, including 4 Critical, 12 High, 14 Medium, and 6 Low severity issues. The codebase has strong foundational accessibility in several areas: public pages have proper ARIA labels, form accessibility is well-implemented on auth pages, and skip navigation exists on the public layout. However, the authenticated app shell has significant gaps: missing landmarks, no prefers-reduced-motion support, color-only status indicators, missing ARIA labels on interactive elements, and inaccessible SVG icons. The most critical finding is that sortable table headers are not keyboard-accessible.

Category	Critical	High	Medium	Low
Keyboard Navigation	1	4	1	0
Screen Readers	0	3	2	3
Semantic HTML	0	2	2	1
Color Contrast	0	1	2	1
Reduced Motion	0	2	3	0
Form Accessibility	0	1	3	1

Critical Findings

K-1: Sortable Table Headers Not Keyboard-Accessible

The sortable column headers in data-table.tsx use a div with onClick and cursor-pointer, but no role="button", tabIndex, or keyboard event handler. Keyboard users cannot trigger sorting. This violates WCAG 2.1.1 Keyboard (Level A). The fix is to replace the div with a button element, or add role="button", tabIndex={0}, and onKeyDown handler for Enter/Space keys.

K-2: No Skip-Link in Authenticated App Layout

The public layout has a skip-to-content link, but the authenticated app layout does not. Keyboard users must tab through the entire sidebar before reaching main content. This violates WCAG 2.4.1 Bypass Blocks (Level A). Add a skip-to-content link before the sidebar and id="main-content" to the main element.

C-1: Color-Only Status Indicator for Unread Notifications

The unread notification indicator is a small blue dot with no text or icon alternative. This relies solely on color to convey "unread" status, violating WCAG 1.4.1 Use of Color (Level A). Add aria-label="Unread" or include a visually hidden text label alongside the dot.

R-1/R-2: Framer Motion Animations Not Respecting prefers-reduced-motion

The motion.div animations in StatCard and QuickActions do not check prefers-reduced-motion. Users with motion sensitivity will see all animations. Use useReducedMotion() from Framer Motion and conditionally disable animations, or wrap in a CSS media query check.

High Severity Findings

Search Inputs Without Labels

The search inputs on the Search page, Marketplace page, and in the DataTable component all lack associated labels or aria-label attributes. Screen readers will announce them as unlabeled text fields. This violates WCAG 1.3.1 and 3.3.2. Add aria-label="Search" to each input.

Icon-Only Buttons Missing Accessible Names

The download invoice button in the billing page contains only a Download icon with no aria-label. Screen readers will announce it as "button" with no context. All "View" buttons in data tables have the same generic text without identifying which row they refer to. This violates WCAG 4.1.2 and 2.4.4.

Notification Status Changes Not Announced

When a user marks a notification as read or deletes it, the optimistic update changes the DOM but does not use aria-live to announce the change. Screen reader users get no feedback. This violates WCAG 4.1.3 Status Messages (Level AA). Add an aria-live="polite" region.

Missing Landmark Regions

The authenticated app layout has aside for the sidebar and main for content, but main has no id for skip-link targeting, and there is no header or nav landmark wrapping the header and sidebar navigation. This violates WCAG 1.3.1.

Date Inputs Not Properly Labeled

The date input elements on the reports page have no associated label or aria-label. The placeholder attribute is not a substitute for a label. This violates WCAG 1.3.1 and 3.3.2.

Password Form Error Not Announced

The password error message in the settings security tab does not have role="alert" or aria-live="assertive". Unlike the auth forms which properly use role="alert", the settings form does not. This violates WCAG 3.3.1 and 4.1.3.

Positive Findings

The public layout has a properly implemented skip-to-content link with focus-visible styles. Auth forms use aria-label, aria-required, role="alert", and autoComplete attributes correctly. The root layout sets lang="en". The mobile nav sheet uses SheetTitle and SheetDescription for screen reader context. The sidebar collapse button has aria-label. Pagination buttons all have aria-label. Custom form components (TextField, SelectField, TextareaField) properly implement aria-invalid, aria-describedby, and htmlFor/id associations.

Top 10 Priority Fixes

Priority	ID	Fix
1	K-1	Make data table sort headers keyboard-accessible
2	K-2	Add skip-link to authenticated layout
3	R-1/R-2	Add prefers-reduced-motion support to Framer Motion
4	C-1	Add non-color indicator for unread notifications
5	SR-9	Add contextual aria-label to all View buttons in data tables
6	SR-8	Add aria-label to icon-only download button in billing
7	K-5/K-6/K-7	Add labels to all search inputs
8	S-4	Add labels to date inputs in reports
9	F-1	Add role="alert" to settings password error
10	SR-4	Add aria-live region for notification action feedback